

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI)

1Q25 earnings review: Confident to ride the near term uncertainty though EPS could face headwinds; Buy

Buy

UOBH.SI 12m Price Target: **S\$41.90** Price: **S\$34.49** Upside: **21.5%**

UOB posted 1Q25 net profit of S\$1,490mn, -1% yoy/-2% qoq, -1% vs. GSe (see [First Take: 1Q25 inline - Reiterates S\\$3bn capital distribution plan but 2025 guidance on hold](#)). Outlook and strategy for 2025 was one of the key focuses at the analyst briefing given macro uncertainty. Management points out that given the highly fluid macro environment, guidance for 2025 will be on hold till there is more clarity - for now we forecast loan growth of 4.0%, NIM of 1.94%, CoC of 31 bps and Non-NII growth of 2% which will see net income declining by 2%. Management notes the bank has done a review of first order impact from tariffs on the portfolio, which is manageable, but review of the second order impact, which is more of a concern, would require more macro assumptions and thus would require more time. The bank does see risk to its previous loan growth target of high single digits, but is cautiously optimistic on margin as it sees further room to manage on the liability side, and on fees given robust momentum seen in 1Q25. On asset quality, UOB sees it as manageable at this moment and does not expect significant deterioration as the Covid period. In light of this, the 14% ROE target by 2026 will also be revisited.

Overall, we view this set of results as inline with expectation, with margin holding up in the rate cut environment and ROE maintained at 12.4%. We view UOB as well-positioned to weather the macro uncertainties with its stronger portfolio and capital position, and commitment for the S\$3bn capital return plan for next 3 years and we remain Buy on UOB. We wait for more update from management on outlook and strategy at next quarter results when there is more clarity on macro. Post results, we revise up our 2025-27 net income estimates by 0.9%/1.3%/2.3%, to S\$5,927mn/S\$6,240mn/ S\$6,679mn as we bake in higher 1Q25 NIM and higher fee income, partly offset by higher credit cost. Our

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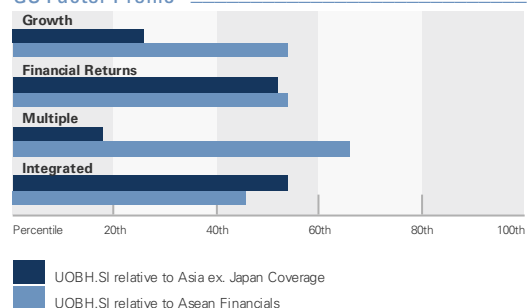
Key Data

Market cap: S\$57.2bn / \$44.3bn
3m ADTV: S\$137.0mn / \$102.9mn
Singapore
Asean Financials
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net inc. (S\$ mn) New	6,044.0	5,927.3	6,240.0	6,679.5
Net inc. (S\$ mn) Old	6,044.0	5,877.2	6,159.9	6,528.4
EPS (S\$) New	3.51	3.50	3.69	3.96
EPS (S\$) Old	3.51	3.47	3.64	3.87
EPS growth (%)	6.0	(0.3)	5.4	7.2
P/E (X)	8.9	9.8	9.3	8.7
P/B (X)	1.1	1.2	1.1	1.1
Price/PPOP (X)	7.0	7.1	6.7	6.3
Dividend yield (%)	7.3	6.7	5.7	6.1
	3/25	6/25E	9/25E	12/25E
EPS (S\$)	0.88	0.86	0.90	0.84

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
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Buy

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI)

Rating since Nov 10, 2024

Ratios & Valuation

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
P/E (X)	8.9	9.8	9.3	8.7
Price/PPOP (X)	7.0	7.1	6.7	6.3
P/B (X)	1.1	1.2	1.1	1.1
P/NTA per share (X)	—	—	—	—
Dividend yield (%)	7.3	6.7	5.7	6.1
Div. payout ratio (%)	64.2	65.0	51.0	51.0

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
BVPS growth	8.1	3.7	4.2	6.5
Total revenue growth	2.6	(0.2)	3.1	5.7
Op. profit growth	0.8	(1.5)	4.7	6.9
Net inc growth	5.8	(1.9)	5.3	7.0
EPS growth	6.0	(0.3)	5.4	7.2
DPS growth	35.3	1.0	(16.1)	7.0

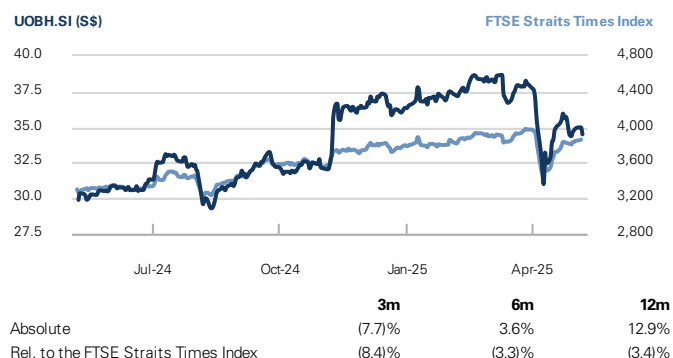
Asset Quality

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Provision charge/total loans (%)	0.3	0.3	0.3	0.3
Gr impaired assets/total loans (%)	1.5	1.6	1.6	1.7
NPL ratio (%)	1.5	1.6	1.6	1.7
Total provisions/total loans (%)	1.2	1.1	1.2	1.2
Specific prov/gr impair assets (%)	31.7	22.5	22.3	22.6
Loan loss reserve/NPLs (%)	75.5	68.7	70.3	71.4

Capital Item

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Basel 3 CET1 ratio (%)	—	—	—	—
Tier 1 capital ratio (%)	16.6	15.8	15.5	15.9

Price Performance



Source: FactSet. Price as of 7 May 2025 close.

Income Statement (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net interest income	9,675.0	9,548.4	9,551.7	9,978.2
Net fees	2,395.0	2,729.9	3,056.9	3,398.4
Treasury income	1,689.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other operating income	535.0	1,985.0	2,099.3	2,164.4
Total revenue	14,294.0	14,263.3	14,707.9	15,541.0
Compensation & benefits exp.	(3,699.0)	—	—	—
Non-employee costs	(2,376.0)	(6,166.1)	(6,227.8)	(6,476.9)
Pre-provision op. profit	8,219.0	8,097.2	8,480.1	9,064.1
Provision for loans	(873.0)	(1,068.9)	(1,083.7)	(1,145.2)
Total provision expense	(926.0)	(1,069.9)	(1,083.7)	(1,145.2)
Income/(loss) from associates	121.0	133.1	139.8	146.7
Pre-tax profit	7,151.0	7,159.4	7,536.1	8,065.7
Provision for taxes	(1,092.0)	(1,217.1)	(1,281.1)	(1,371.2)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	6,044.0	5,927.3	6,240.0	6,679.5
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	5,925.7	5,809.0	6,121.6	6,561.2
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$\$)	3.58	3.58	3.82	4.09
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (basic, post-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (\$\$)	3.51	3.50	3.69	3.96
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	1,685.9	1,657.9	1,657.9	1,657.9
Avg. yield on loans (%)	5.2	4.8	4.6	4.5
Gr yld. on int. earning assets (%)	4.6	4.1	3.8	3.7
Cost of fund (%)	3.0	2.5	2.2	2.2
Net interest margin (%)	1.9	1.8	1.8	1.8

Balance Sheet (\$\$ mn)

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Domestic mortgages	82,036.0	85,397.6	90,043.1	95,355.6
Domestic non-mortgages	29,914.0	31,139.8	32,833.8	34,770.9
Domestic commercial lending	206,447.0	214,906.6	226,597.2	239,966.3
Total overseas lending, gross	—	—	—	—
Gross loans to customers	338,000.0	351,674.3	370,804.9	392,682.2
Total NPLs, gross	5,164.0	5,727.3	6,113.0	6,552.2
Total loan loss reserve	3,901.0	3,935.5	4,296.7	4,678.5
Net customer loans & advances	333,930.0	347,738.8	366,508.2	388,003.7
Other interest earning assets	86,112.0	87,486.9	89,418.5	91,434.1
Interest earning assets	509,332.0	529,845.2	554,188.4	581,963.8
Other non-int. earning assets	28,332.0	28,768.1	28,721.8	28,669.1
Total assets	537,664.0	558,613.2	582,910.2	610,652.9
Risk weighted assets	259,835.0	279,299.9	291,448.1	305,319.1
CASA deposits	220,644.0	235,934.9	252,164.4	269,604.4
Non-CASA deposits	183,334.0	186,670.1	193,475.9	200,553.8
Customer deposits	403,978.0	422,605.0	445,640.3	470,158.2
Other paying liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other liabilities	19,879.0	19,879.0	19,879.0	19,879.0
Total liabilities	487,707.0	507,730.3	530,765.5	555,283.4
Total shareholders' equity	49,957.0	50,883.0	52,144.7	55,369.4
Total liabilities & equity	537,664.0	558,613.2	582,910.2	610,652.9
BVPS (\$\$)	27.87	28.89	30.12	32.08
RWA/assets (%)	48.3	50.0	50.0	50.0

Profit Drivers

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Net customer loan growth (%)	5.3	4.1	5.4	5.9
Net interest margin (%)	1.9	1.8	1.8	1.8
Fee income ratio (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Cost/income (ex. goodwill) (%)	42.3	43.2	42.3	41.7
Tax rate (%)	15.3	17.0	17.0	17.0
CASA ratio (%)	54.6	55.8	56.6	57.3
Net cust. loans/deposits (%)	82.7	82.3	82.2	82.5

Profitability

	12/24	12/25E	12/26E	12/27E
Op. revenue/avg. assets (%)	2.7	2.6	2.6	2.6
Op. expenses/avg. assets (%)	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Pre-provision ROA (%)	1.5	1.5	1.5	1.5
Loan loss prov./avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
Pre-tax profit/avg. assets (%)	1.3	1.3	1.3	1.4
Prov. for inc. tax/avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
ROA (%)	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Leverage (X)	10.8	11.0	11.2	11.0
ROE (%)	13.1	12.2	12.6	12.9
ROE (pre-exception.) (%)	12.5	11.8	12.1	12.4

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

12-m 2-stage DDM target price is unchanged at S\$41.9.

More details from the briefing:

- **NIM has more room to manage on the liability side but uncertainty lies on asset side.** UOB maintained 1Q25 NIM at 2.0%, with exit NIM of 1.98%, as proactive management of liability helped to offset downward pressure on loans given declining benchmark rates. UOB has lowered NIM sensitivity to 1.2bps per 25bps Fed rate cut. Looking forward, UOB sees more room to manage on the liability side, including the impact from UOB One Account interest rate cut to materialize in from 2Q and to shorten the duration of wholesale funding. With that said, the NIM outlook remains closely tied to tariff policy and monetary policy. We forecast NIM of 1.94% for 2025 as we baked in 5 additional Fed cuts in our numbers.
- **US tariff impact on loan growth requires time to materialize.** Given the uncertainty and volatility in macro environment, UOB does see risks to its previous loan growth guidance of high single digit. However, the bank believes now is too early to quantify the impact as the US tariff was just announced a month ago with several changes awaiting confirmation. On the positive side, UOB believes there is opportunity to increase trade activities within ASEAN and between ASEAN-China. We forecast loan growth of 4.0% for 2025.
- **Wealth income momentum remains strong.** The bank noted though AUM was flattish qoq, there was S\$1.5-2bn net new money inflow in 1Q25 but offset by valuation movements. UOB noticed that the wealth momentum continued in Apr and customers are adopting a “wait-and-hold” strategy instead of fleeing away from market. 1Q25 fee income was also boosted by IBD fees from several large syndication deals which might not recur in 2Q25. We forecast fee income growth of 14% for 2025 to factor in the stronger than expected wealth momentum.
- **Do not expect major credit crunch due to the tariff policy.** UOB noted the increase of GP in 1Q was due to prudent provisioning to buffer up for the macro uncertainties. UOB targets to increase GP to total loan coverage to 90bps, from current 80bps, but no timeline specified. UOB expects the US tariff would mainly affect growth rather than on asset quality, and believes that any deterioration in asset quality will be less severe than Covid period given stronger balance sheet. UOB believes the asset quality remains manageable and the small uptick of NPL in 1Q25 was due to downgrade of an HK property loan and was fully provisioned. We forecast 31bps credit cost for 2025.

Key risks: (-) Unexpected acceleration or deeper Fed rate cuts; (-) Poor execution of growth strategy in Citi franchise; (-) Unexpected deterioration in asset quality.

Exhibit 1: UOB 1Q25 Results Summary

Income statement (\$\$mn)						YoY %		QoQ %		Actual vs. Est	
	1Q24	2Q24	3Q24	4Q24	1Q25					1Q25E	(%)
Net Interest Income	2,362	2,401	2,460	2,452	2,409	2	(2)			2,410	(0)
Fee & Commission	580	618	630	567	694	20	22			650	7
Other Non-Interest Income	581	457	744	442	554	(5)	25			456	21
Non-Interest Income	1,161	1,075	1,374	1,009	1,248	7	24			1,106	13
Operating Income	3,523	3,476	3,834	3,461	3,657	4	6			3,516	4
Operating Expenses	(1,475)	(1,451)	(1,590)	(1,559)	(1,559)	6	-			(1,475)	6
Pre-Prov Op Profit (PPOP)	2,048	2,025	2,244	1,902	2,098	2	10			2,041	3
Loan Loss Provisions	(163)	(232)	(304)	(227)	(290)	78	28			(238)	22
Pre-tax Profit	1,825	1,718	1,923	1,685	1,822	(0)	8			1,817	0
Net Profit	1,502	1,410	1,610	1,522	1,490	(1)	(2)			1,504	(1)
Balance sheet (\$\$mn)											
Assets	515,340	516,743	541,885	537,664	538,009	4	0			544,644	(1)
Gross Loans	322,634	327,600	333,998	338,000	341,154	5.7	0.9			341,292	(0)
Non-Performing Loans	4,840	4,888	5,010	5,164	5,458	13	6			5,233	4
Customer Deposits	388,472	389,157	400,784	403,978	401,250	3	(1)			409,469	(2)
CAMEL Ratios (%)											
Core Tier 1	13.9	13.4	15.2	15.4	15.4					15.9	
NPL Ratio	1.50	1.49	1.50	1.53	1.60					1.53	
Provisions / Average Loans (bps)	20	29	37	27	34					28	
Reported Net Interest Margin	2.02	2.05	2.05	2.00	2.00					1.96	
Cost-to-Income Ratio	41.9	41.7	41.5	45.0	42.6					41.9	
Loan-to-Deposits	83.1	84.2	83.3	83.7	85.0					83.3	

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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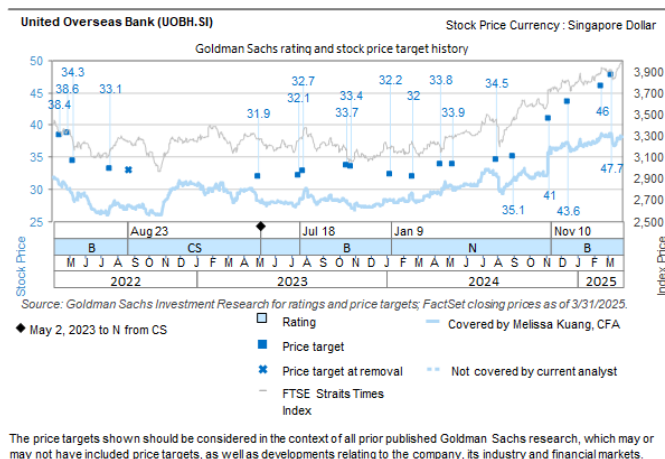
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Price target and rating history chart(s)



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